

HEMANTH POONDLA

AI / GenAI Engineer

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SUMMARY

Full-stack product engineer with 6+ years building enterprise web and mobile applications, now working as an AI/GenAI Engineer. Built internal AI tooling in production at Temenos, including an AI-assisted code review workflow, prompt optimization for team tooling, and a retrieval-based documentation assistant. Completed a structured, self-directed transition covering ML fundamentals through production LLM systems, and shipped four applied AI projects spanning retrieval-augmented generation, agentic workflows, and the Model Context Protocol (MCP). Comfortable owning a system end to end, from data pipeline and model integration through to a production-grade UI.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript / JavaScript, SQL

GenAI / LLM Engineering: LangChain, LangGraph, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Prompt Engineering, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Agentic Workflows, LLM API Integration (OpenAI, Anthropic)

ML / Deep Learning: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, NumPy, Pandas, scikit-learn

Vector Search & Data: Vector Embeddings, Semantic Search, Chroma, Pinecone

Backend / APIs: FastAPI, REST API design

Infra / Tooling: Git, GitHub, Docker, AWS, Agile

Frontend / Platforms: React.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6), HTML, CSS, Node.js

Core CS / Backend: Java, SQL, DBMS, Data Structures, MVC

APPLIED AI PROJECTS

Code and write-ups: github.com/hemanth-poondda

FinX: AI-Powered Expense Categorization | Personal product (live, 1,000+ transactions processed) *Upgraded Aug 2026*

Live: finx.werde.app

- Replaced FinX's original rule-based SMS and email parsing with a fine-tuned transformer text classifier to fix consistent misclassification on irregular bank message formats.
- Labeled a real dataset from months of parsed transaction text, fine-tuned a Hugging Face transformer model in PyTorch, and evaluated it against held-out data.
- Shipped the model into the live product, replacing the categorization layer without disrupting the existing trend-analysis and reporting features.

Document RAG Assistant | Personal project

Sep-Oct 2026

- Built a retrieval-augmented generation pipeline to answer questions over a personal travel-research knowledge base, after realizing how much manual searching went into planning a Kazakhstan trip.
- Tuned the chunking and embedding strategy to balance retrieval precision against LLM context cost, backed by a vector store for semantic search.
- Added a citation step so answers stay grounded in the source documents instead of the model's general knowledge.

MCP Server for Personal App Tools | Personal project

Nov 2026

- Designed a Model Context Protocol server exposing read-only tools over real application data: expense lookups and category totals from FinX, balance checks from Settle.
- Scoped every tool to read-only operations with clear input and output schemas, so an LLM agent can query personal financial data without any risk of unintended writes.
- Tested the server against an MCP-compatible client to confirm tool discovery and invocation worked end to end, not just in isolation.

Multi-Step Trip Planning Agent | Personal project

Dec 2026-Jan 2027

- Built a LangGraph agent that chains multiple tool calls to solve a real multi-step task: research a destination through the RAG assistant, check spending capacity through the FinX MCP tools, then produce a structured trip proposal within budget.
- Carried state across steps (retrieved research, budget limits, partial plan) so the agent could revise its proposal if a suggested itinerary went over budget.
- Capstone project that ties together retrieval, tool use, and agentic reasoning in one working system.

Other Work: mywayaround.blog - a full-stack travel content platform with auth, newsletter, and a trip-matching quiz, built and shipped independently.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified AI Practitioner** - Amazon Web Services
- **Generative AI with LLMs** - DeepLearning.AI
- **LangChain for LLM Application Development** - LangChain Academy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Engineer | Temenos India Pvt. Ltd. (formerly Kony India Pvt. Ltd.) *Feb 2023 - Present*

- Built and rolled out an AI-assisted code review tool for the team, using LLM-based analysis to flag issues and speed up review turnaround.
- Iterated on prompt design and evaluation for internal LLM tooling, improving the reliability and consistency of generated output.
- Created a retrieval-based documentation assistant, applying RAG in a production context to make team documentation searchable in natural language.
- Delivered a unified UX redesign for Supply Chain Finance that became a consistently top-ranked interface internally.
- Partnered across teams to build new features for a recently acquired corporate origination banking product, including deals and facilities workflows.

Software Development Engineer | Temenos India Pvt. Ltd. (formerly Kony India Pvt. Ltd.) *Dec 2020 - Jan 2023*

- Led development of Trade Finance features in a Corporate Banking Application, including Import LC, Export LC, Issued and Received Guarantees, and Inward and Outward Collections.
- Mentored and trained a team of four new developers to full role competency.
- Modularized a large Retail Banking application into smaller, more efficient micro-apps and built out its Payments Module.

Associate Software Development Engineer | Kony India Pvt. Ltd. *Jun 2019 - Nov 2020*

- Contributed to Online and Mobile Banking modules including User Management and Foreign Exchange, owning UI development, feature builds, and critical bug fixes.
- Cut operating costs by revising and modularizing legacy codebases, converting a monolithic banking UI into reusable components.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science, Keshav Memorial Institute of Technology - 2016 to 2020

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Silver 4-Star Rating in Python Programming, HackerRank
- Silver 3-Star Rating in Problem Solving, HackerRank
- Ranked #1 performer for two consecutive years; Team Award for Excellent Performance, Q4 2020 (Temenos)
- Earned Backend Developer Associate and Front End Developer Associate badges at Kony India Pvt. Ltd.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Subject Matter Expert (Java, DBMS) | Chegg Inc. *Mar 2021 - Oct 2022, Remote*

- Helped students work through Java, DBMS, and core computer science concepts, maintaining a subject-matter confidence score above 90%.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

- College Lead, Rally for Rivers
- Captain, College Cricket Team
- Member, Street Cause